Visual Art 2025

Sample teaching, learning and assessment plan

Unit 2: Art as code

Unit description

In Unit 2, students explore the concept of ‘art as code’ to learn how visual language is capable of expressing complex ideas. Although both spoken language and visual language vary by culture, visual language has the potential to transcend and communicate across cultures, time and geography.

Students apply the contexts, foregrounding the formal and the cultural contexts to analyse an interpret visual communication and meaning in artworks. As students make and respond teachers unpack the art processes of creating a body of work. Students are guided through the development of an individualised focus through learning experiences that facilitate more student-directed investigation and experimentation.

Students use a range of art materials, techniques, technologies and processes to create a folio, including experimental work, artist research and a least one resolved artwork.

Through the inquiry learning process, students explore how visual language, symbol systems and art conventions can express ideas and feelings in images, objects and experiences. They experiment with language in art that can be verbal, inaudible, literal or implied, narrative metaphoric, persuasive, or decorative. They employ a range of art materials, techniques, technologies and processes to make artworks that may be ephemeral or permanent, physical or digital.

As audience, students examine the art practices, and read and interpret artworks of Australia and international artists who innovatively exploit cross-cultural meaning and communication through visual language. As artists, students communicate fluently and expressively through visual forms and engage with audiences to express their ideas.

Unit objectives

1. Implement ideas and representations to decode artworks and communicate in visual forms.
2. Apply literacy skills to communicate understanding of visual language, expression and meaning in the work of self and others.
3. Analyse and interpret artworks and art practices through the formal and cultural contexts.
4. Evaluate influences to examine how diverse symbol systems are used by artists to communicate meaning.
5. Justify viewpoints using evidence of communication in artworks.
6. Experiment in response to symbol systems used by artists to communicate meaning.
7. Create visual responses with multiple meanings and representations using knowledge and understanding of media.
8. Realise responses to demonstrate how meaning is communicated through art forms.

Assessment plan

Assessment details	%	Objectives to be assessed	Conditions	Date
Unit 2: Project	—	1. Implement ideas and representations to decode artworks and communicate in visual forms. 2. Apply literacy skills to communicate understanding of visual language, expression and meaning in the work of self and others. 3. Analyse and interpret artworks and art practices through the formal and cultural contexts. 4. Evaluate influences to examine how diverse symbol systems are used by artists to communicate meaning. 5. Justify viewpoints using evidence of communication in artworks. 6. Experiment in response to symbol systems used by artists to communicate meaning. 7. Create visual responses with multiple meanings and representations using knowledge and understanding of media. 8. Realise responses to demonstrate how meaning is communicated through art forms.	• Students must be given continuous class time to develop their inquiry-based folio project. • Selection of 4–8 developmental artworks. Selected artworks do not require resolution. • One resolved work that extends from one of the development artworks • Reflection through display and exhibition including an artist statement • Teacher-directed media area/s	At the end of the unit

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Assessment details	%	Objectives to be assessed	Conditions	Date
Unit 2: Examination	—	1. Implement ideas and representations to decode artworks and communicate in visual forms. 2. Apply literacy skills to communicate understanding of visual language, expression and meaning in the work of self and others. 3. Analyse and interpret art practices through the formal and cultural contexts. 4. Evaluate influences to examine how diverse symbol systems are used by artists to communicate meaning 5. Justify viewpoints using evidence of communication in artworks.	• Extended response • Time: 2 hours plus 20 minutes working time • Mode: Written	At the end of the unit

Teaching and learning plan

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
		For concurrent delivery: • swap order of Units 1 and 2 • this unit will be delivered before Unit 1 'Art as lens' • this unit will be partnered with Unit 3 'Art as knowledge' • 'Art as code' and 'Art as knowledge' use the same direct stimulus or experience as a starting point for learning and assessment • 'Art as lens' and 'Art as alternate' develop from new ways of looking at and interpreting meaning from ideas in 'Art as code' and 'Art as knowledge' • mirror assessment for 'Art as code' with 'Art as knowledge'.	
6 hours	**Reflecting** How do artists consider ideas and information, media techniques and processes? Students: • reflect on languages in artworks and the dialogue between artist and audience as they consider ideas and information, media, techniques and processes • evaluate the various ways artists communicate ideas through visual language and expression, such as – how artists communicate ideas using non-linguistic symbols in ephemeral artworks. **Developing** How do artists generate solutions to visual problems? Students: • create visual responses to communicate cultural ideas and formal theories through manipulation of visual language, art materials, techniques, technologies and processes in a range of – two-dimensional artworks, such as line, tone, colour, shape and texture; composition, balance, repetition, contrast, harmony, emphasis and unity. **Key terminology** How do artists and audiences write and talk about art? Students: • build on and apply visual art terminology when writing about and talking about artworks of self and others as they become familiar with the following key terms – body of work — consists of individual student responses to making and responding tasks that integrate concept, focus, context and media; may lead to a single work or a collection of works, related to each other in some way, with each one being as important as the other – ephemeral — lasting for only a short period of time – express — convey, show or communicate (e.g. a thought, opinion, feeling, emotion, idea or viewpoint) – focus — individual student pathways that define interpretations and responses to the concepts; over the two-year course, the teacher will structure units of work emphasising a progression from teacher-	**Introduction** • Responding: – class watches 2015 talk *Chromatics* by Jake Neville (Cairns State High School — 2015 Creative Generation participant) or Neil Harbisson's 2012 TED Talk *I listen to color* – lead a discussion of how artists consider ideas and information about colour and technology. • Making: – students ▪ undertake studies in monochrome: developing ideas that art elements, especially colour, underpin many facets of our lives ▪ identify one colour as the focus for the following experimental exercises (favourite colour, random selection) ▪ undertake a case study, e.g. Sol LeWitt, *Color Bands*, 2000; Olafur Eliasson, *Your Body of Work*, 2011; Patricia Piccinini, *Verdant*, 2005 ▪ use monochromatic painting processes; mix, blend and create various hues, tints and shades of the chosen colour and represent the colour in an abstract composition ▪ take a minimum of 20 photographs of objects and images that represent the student's chosen colour ▪ focus on the elements (line, tone, shape, texture) and principles (pattern, repetition, contrast, unity, balance); print, display and evaluate the mood or expression generated by the collection of colours ▪ explore collaborative processes — collect up to 20 objects that represent hues, tints and shades of chosen colour; collaborate with peers that have the same colour by photographing the objects in various settings, locations, configurations ▪ address the formal qualities of the objects through a focus on the elements and principles such as tone, shape, texture, scale, composition, balance, repetition, contrast, harmony, unity ▪ void of colour — using student's personal objects, remove the colour by spraying in neutrals, wrapping in brown paper or string, bleaching objects, peeling surfaces etc.; rephotograph the objects in new settings, locations and configurations ▪ undertake a case study, e.g. ○ Ai Weiwei, *Colored Vases*, 2007–12 ○ Ricky Swallow, *Killing Time*, 2003–4	• Students to collect personal, general and found objects that are not precious, can be manipulated and can possibly be deconstructed **Suggested artists/artworks and stimulus** • Ai Weiwei, *Colored Vases*, 2007–12, https://tba21.org/colored_vases • Chiharu Shiota, *Uncertain journey*, 2016–2019, www.qagoma.qld.gov.au/stories/chiharu-shiota-an-uncertain-journey-the-soul-trembles-brisbane-australia • Jake Neville, 2015, *Chromatics*, 0:00–2:30 (student film — Cairns State High School — 2015 Creative Generation participant), www.youtube.com/watch?v=bDoaz1PuI60 • Jenna Lee, *Bound by thread*, 2021, https://jennalee.art/ill-lustrous-deep-wounds-cut-from-shell • Jill Chism, *Breathe*, 2006, https://envart.jillchism.com.au/albums/Breathe/album • Louise Nevelson, *Sky Cathedral*, 1958, www.moma.org/collection/works/81006 • Moderna Museet, 2015, *Olafur Eliasson on Seu corpo da obra (Your body of work)* (online talk at Moderna Museet in connection with the exhibition 'Olafur Eliasson: Reality machines', 3 October 2015 – 17 January 2016), www.youtube.com/watch?v=KE-Y3jJ4Lp8 • Neil Harbisson, 2012, *I listen to color* (talk presented at TEDGlobal2012), www.ted.com/talks/neil_harbisson_i_listen_to_color • Patricia Piccinini, *Verdant*, 2005, www.roslynoxley9.com.au/artwork/patricia-piccinini-verdant-2005/31:970 • Ricky Swallow, *Killing Time*, 2003–04, www.artgallery.nsw.gov.au/collection/works/125.2004 • Simryn Gill, *Garland*, 2006–12, https://netsvictoria.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2015/09/Simryn-GillEducation-resource.pdf • Sol LeWitt, *Color Bands*, 2000, https://americanart.si.edu/artwork/color-bands-78779

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
	directed focus, through teacher–student negotiated focus, to the students selecting and interpreting their own focus to resolve work – symbol — something that stands for something else or represents an idea; may be in the form of visual forms, gestures, words or sounds.	○ Simryn Gill, *Garland*, 2006–12 ○ Louise Nevelson, *Sky Cathedral*, 1958 ○ Jill Chism, *Breathe*, 2006 ○ Jenna Lee, *Bound by thread*, 2021 ○ Chiharu Shiota, *Uncertain journey*, 2016-2019.	
5 hours	**Developing** Students: • implement ideas in visual responses that explore – expression, art elements and principles to develop personal symbol systems to represent and communicate meaning in artworks. **Researching** How do artists react to stimulus? Students: • research diverse art-making approaches and 'read' visual language as they react to stimulus • analyse and compare artworks through the cultural context to interpret social influences and representations of time, place, politics, purpose, ethnicity, gender and spiritual and secular beliefs on visual language and communication, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning through – making, students explore cultural values, historical or current events, social pressures, and attitudes that affect them and others, and determine the origins of social meaning communicated in artwork – responding, students consider Aboriginal perspectives; regional, national, international, social and cultural identity of artists and audiences; and how artists use their work as a vehicle to invite change and provoke conversation • analyse and compare artworks through the formal context to interpret formal visual art elements and principles, the application of materials and techniques, the stylistic qualities relative to historical periods or iconology, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning; through – making, students focus on the formal organisation and placement of visual components, experimenting with codes, symbols, and art conventions, and the communicative value of art materials, techniques and processes – responding, students decode artworks by reading the relationships between specific visual language, signs, symbols, codes, and conventions that are used to transmit information and ideas in artworks • experiment with a range of visual responses to explore communication through art language, such as – representation and communication of abstract ideas using art elements and principles – ideas of symbol systems and invented codes as decorative shape, form and pattern. **Key terminology** How do artists and audiences write and talk about art?	• Introduction to inquiry learning processes, formal context and cultural context to analyse and interpret visual communication and meaning in artworks through concept of Art as code: – developing — how do artists generate solutions to visual problems? – researching — how do artists react to stimulus? – reflecting — how do artists consider ideas and information, media techniques and processes? – resolving — how do artists communicate individual ideas as visual, written or spoken responses? –key terminology— how do artists and audiences write and talk about art? • Responding: – engage students with comparison of two contemporary artists as a case study using a double bubble through online research – use inquiry questions to discuss artworks and art practice – use annotated sketches of artworks that can be formulated into written paragraph responses to articulate formal and cultural analysis and interpretation of artworks – apply reverse chronology to analyse both artists' work to underpin the cultural and formal contexts – analyse and interpret how both artists manipulate cultural forms in the generation of symbols in contemporary practice – undertake a case study, e.g. Brook Andrew, *Ancestral Worship*, 2010; Vernon Ah Kee, *Cant Chant*, 2009 • Formal context guiding questions: – How do artists use formal organisation and placement of visual components to communicate information, ideas and issues? – How do artists manipulate materials and techniques to enhance meaning? – How is knowledge of art conventions and symbols applied by the viewer when decoding artworks? • Cultural context guiding questions: – How do cultural values impact and influence perspectives of both the artists and audience? – How do artists use their work as a vehicle to invite cultural change and provoke conversation? – How do artists comment on and draw meaning from historical, technological or social events? • Making activities in response to artist case study: – students design a pattern that will become a cover for a contemporary purpose (e.g. mobile phone cover, skateboard deck, laptop techskin, or other functional object) that relies purely on the abstraction of a personal symbol by reducing form and colour	**Suggested artists/artworks and stimulus** • Brook Andrew, *Ancestral Worship*, 2010, www.ngv.vic.gov.au/explore/collection/work/144842 • Patricia Piccinini, *Verdant,* 2005, www.roslynoxley9.com.au/artwork/patricia-piccinini-verdant-2005/31:970 • Wiradjuri Tribe tree carving, Carved Trees: Aboriginal cultures of western NSW, State Library of New South Wales, 2011, www.anbg.gov.au/aboriginalresources/Carved-Trees-GuideState-Library-NSW-3449.pdf • Vernon Ah Kee, *Cant Chant*, 2009, www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZDVU5eZ3kFU • Yidinji people, *Shields*,1903, The National Museum of Australia, www.nma.gov.au/exhibitions/encounters/mapping/cairns

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
	Students: • apply visual art terminology when writing about and talking about artworks of self and others as they become familiar with the following key terms: – art conventions — established procedures used by artists to represent or organise ideas, convey meaning and create aesthetic value – contemporary art — the work of artists who are living and producing in the 21st century; contemporary art mirrors contemporary culture and society – contexts — frames of reference that inform the concepts and focuses, allowing intended and suggested meaning to evolve; in Unit 2 these contexts include cultural and formal perspectives – symbol systems — personal, cultural or global language that communicates when read and interpreted by the viewer; artists communicate through combinations of art-form conventions and symbol systems.	– symbol could stem from religious symbols, cultural icons, zodiac astronomy, family crests, school logo, country of origin flags patterns – draw, paint or generate this design using traditional or contemporary devices.	
7 hours	**Developing** Students: • develop art-making methods that communicate through codes, symbols, visual language and art conventions as they generate solutions to visual problems • implement ideas in visual responses that explore – expression, art elements and principles to develop personal symbol systems to represent and communicate meaning in artworks – elements as communication, such as the minimal mark to represent a figure, an expression, a concept, an object – personalised symbols and expressive visual language to communicate an individualised focus • create visual responses to communicate cultural ideas and formal theories through manipulation of visual language, materials, techniques, processes and technologies of – two-dimensional artworks, such as line, tone, colour, shape and texture; composition, balance, repetition, contrast, harmony, emphasis and unity – time-based media, such as time, movement, sound, silence, rhythm, lighting, colour, sequence, pace, movement, focus and tone – three-dimensional artworks, such as colour, texture, form, surface, scale, mass, movement, volume, unity, symmetry, repetition • develop an awareness of appropriate health and safety practices for art materials and techniques in respect to both themselves and the environment. **Researching** Students: • research diverse art-making approaches and 'read' visual language as they react to stimulus • analyse and compare artworks through the cultural context to interpret social influences and representations of time, place, politics, purpose, ethnicity, gender and spiritual and secular beliefs on visual language and communication, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning through	**Formative assessment: Project — Experimental folio** • Investigate colour and abstraction as visual codes to create an experimental folio. **Focus: Cultural signals** • Context: Formal and cultural — formal organisation and cultural identity • Responding: – students ▪ identify cultures and places that employ colour and symbols to connect to culture, e.g. Nepalese prayer flags ▪ research and document the artistic practice of the case study artists, with significant reflection about their use of symbols as code ▪ include appropriate referencing conventions using citations ▪ share through class discussion ideas about installation, ephemeral work and suspension as an exhibition device ▪ react to stimulus with a cultural context case study, e.g. Xu Bing, *The Living Word*, 2001, Kyra Mancktelow, *Gubba Up*, 2021–22 ▪ react to stimulus with a formal context case study, e.g. Christo and Jeanne-Claude, *The Gates,* 1979–2005; Tamika Grant-Iramu, *Complex Ecologies III*, 2021 ▪ annotate each artwork. • Making: – students ▪ investigate reduction of cultural forms — select an image or object that informs the student's ethnicity, spirituality or culture ▪ photocopy or draw the image or object; reduce the image to simplistic line and shape; experiment with different drawing media and approaches through varied application of formal elements and principles ▪ print or transfer the design onto fabric, light papers or sheets of transparent/translucent plastic ▪ install and display, experimenting with suspension and movement through devices, e.g. kite, umbrella, windsock, sail, flag, bunting, curtain, pinwheel, streamers	• A single, symbolically cultural iconic object or image, provided by student • Drawing materials such as bold markers, paint pens • Fabric, transparent papers, plastic sheeting, sewing machines, cotton, thread needles **Suggested artists/artworks and stimulus** • Christo and Jeanne-Claude, *The Gates, Central park, New York City, 1979–2005*, https://christojeanneclaude.net/artworks/the-gates • Christo and Jeanne-Claude's *The Gates*, www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZajjmNT9NOE • Kyra Mancktelow, *Gubba Up*, 2021–22, www.nsmithgallery.com/exhibitions/119-kyra-mancktelow-gubba-up.-n.smith-gallery/installation_shots • Nepalese prayer flags, https://tnp.org/5-things-to-know-about-tibetan-prayer-flags • Tamika Grant-Iramu, *Complex Ecologies III*, 2021, https://onespace.com.au/product/tamika-grant-iramu-complex-ecologies-iii • Xu Bing, *The Living Word*, 2001, The Morgan Library & Museum, www.themorgan.org/exhibitions/xu-bing

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
	– making, students explore cultural values, historical or current events, social pressures, and attitudes that affect them and others, and determine the origins of social meaning communicated in artwork – responding, students consider Aboriginal perspectives; regional, national, international, social and cultural identity of artists and audiences; and how artists use their work as a vehicle to invite change and provoke conversation	▪ video and photograph the installation ▪ record and evaluate audience reaction and interaction with the work.	
7 hours	• analyse and compare artworks through the formal context to interpret formal visual art elements and principles, the application of materials and techniques, the stylistic qualities relative to historical periods or iconology, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning; through – making, students focus on the formal organisation and placement of visual components, experimenting with codes, symbols, and art conventions, and the communicative value of art materials, techniques and processes – responding, students decode artworks by reading the relationships between specific visual language, signs, symbols, codes, and conventions that are used to transmit information and ideas in artworks • analyse and interpret – artworks in teacher-directed, reverse-chronology case studies to investigate historical influences on contemporary artists who incorporate literal and non-literal symbols into artwork – manipulation of cultural forms in the generation of symbols in the work of contemporary artists from Australia's diverse cultures and contexts, including artwork by Aboriginal peoples and Torres Strait Islander peoples (be sensitive to interpretation, context and integrity when discussing the cultural value of subject matter, styles and imagery, sensitive materials, stereotypes and the use of biographical materials) • experiment with a range of visual responses to explore communication through art language, such as – representation and communication of abstract ideas using art elements and principles – decoding expressive language, signs, iconography, symbols and visual language – deconstruction and reconstruction of recognisable symbols, such as text, to explore non-figurative, expressive art forms and visual elements, such as line and shape – ideas of symbol systems and invented codes as decorative shape, form and pattern – enhancing and conveying meaning and aesthetic appeal through exploitation and manipulation of media, appropriation artworks and inspirational art practices – sound as a representation of place – body language, facial expression, costume, props, background in figurative art forms.	**Focus: Statistically speaking** Context: Formal — formal organisation • Responding: – students ▪ investigate a purist approach to colour and shape as a means of communicating formal ideas ▪ research Australian artists Louisa Bufardeci and Rebecca Baumann ▪ respond to stimulus — work of Mark Rothko ▪ employ reverse chronology to explore the concept of colour theory with a historical study. • Extended paragraph response: – students ▪ analyse and interpret formal qualities in artworks that deconstruct and reconstruct formal colour and geometric shape ▪ write an extended paragraph response ▪ analyse through the formal context and reverse chronology to compare work of unseen artists: Gary Lang, *Redrisingtwo*, 2016; Josef Albers, *Homage to square*, 1965; Frank Stella, *Hyena stomp*, 1962. • Making: – students ▪ document a behaviour, routine, disposition or trait comprehensively every day for a week of self or others ▪ compile written and/or visual evidence at predetermined points of time or events through each day at school, own street, shopping centre, home, etc. ▪ devise a code or key to represent the compiled data ▪ use colour and shape differentiation to plan and design a response ▪ create an abstracted artwork using student choice of two-dimensional, three-dimensional or time-based media.	**Suggested artists/artworks** • Frank Stella, *Hyena stomp*, 1962, www.tate.org.uk/art/artworks/stella-hyena-stomp-t00730 • Gary Lang, *Redrisingtwo*, 2016, www.youtube.com/watch?v=5-pA3UbjVPE • Josef Albers, *Homage to square*, 1965, www.artgallery.nsw.gov.au/collection/works/OO1.1967 • Louisa Bufardeci, *Team Joy*, 2004; *There are a few facts I think you ought to know*, 2001–02; *13 captured telephone conversations — all one minute long*, 2006, www.louisabufardeci.net/index.html • Mark Rothko, *Orange, Red, Yellow*, 1961, www.markrothko.org/orange-red-yellow • Rebecca Baumann, *Automated Colour Field*, 2011, Museum of Contemporary Art Australia, www.mca.com.au/collection/artworks/2011.20
4 hours		**Focus: Gender-specific** Context: Cultural — social influences • Responding: – students ▪ record lists of gender-specific objects, activities, roles and responsibilities designated as either masculine or feminine ▪ discuss how society impacts established notions of gender starting with current socially accepted ideals and use reverse chronology to backtrack through to World War II and Hitler's impact on colour change, late 1700s Gainsborough and 1400s with Renaissance and religious iconography ▪ read about the history of blue; use a similar format to create a document that explores pink or another specific colour.	**Suggested artists/artworks and stimulus** • Gottesman, S 2016, 'The 6,000-year history of blue pigments in art', *Artsy*, 30 November, www.artsy.net/article/artsy-editorial-a-brief-history-of-blue • Maglaty, J 2011, 'When did girls start wearing pink?', *Smithsonian*, www.smithsonianmag.com/arts-culture/when-did-girls-start-wearing-pink-1370097 • Nicole Rudolph, 2024, *The Actual History of Pink for Girls and Blue for Boys*, www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y7KLVYYuYIY • Sandro Botticelli, *Madonna and Child*, 1480–81, www.nga.gov/collection/art-object-page.23.html • Thomas Gainsborough, *Portrait of Anne, Countess of Chesterfield*, 1777–78, www.getty.edu/art/collection/object/103RB1T • Thomas Gainsborough, *The Boy in Pink*, 1798–99, https://waddesdon.org.uk/whats-on/gainsborough-pink-boy

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
	Reflecting Students: • reflect on languages in artworks and the dialogue between artist and audience as they consider ideas and information, media, techniques and processes • evaluate the various ways artists communicate ideas through visual language and expression, such as – innovative and expressive, non-linguistic communication in diverse practices, traditions, and cultures by examining past and present influences on contemporary artists, including the work of Aboriginal peoples and Torres Strait Islander peoples, and contemporary artists from Asia – how artists communicate ideas using non-linguistic symbols in ephemeral artworks – artworks that communicate literal and conceptual meaning using familiar and unfamiliar text or other symbol systems – the use of familiar and unfamiliar language systems as methods of communication – the impact of relationships between artist and audience in the construction of meaning • justify – individual art practice by documenting process to make meaningful connections and inform the progress with making work – how artists' intentions and visual language components combine to communicate meaning using visual forms alone • reflect on audience reaction and engagement with artworks that cross language barriers to communicate. **Resolving** How do artists communicate individual ideas as visual, written or spoken responses? Students: • apply – literacy knowledge and skills to understand form and structure of extended paragraphs and essay responses – visual art terminology when decoding and verbalising visual clues and symbols in artworks of self and others – language conventions to construct written responses that analyse, interpret, evaluate and justify visual language, expression and meaning in artworks – referencing conventions to acknowledge sourced information and ideas when researching artists and their practices, and developing artwork approaches – literacy skills to construct an artist's statement that assists the understanding of intended meaning – critical literacies across visual, aural, kinaesthetic, spatial and multimodal devices to assist learning when interpreting and making meaning.	• Making: – students ▪ explore and exploit ideas about gender-specific imagery using colour to transform symbols; consider colour and gender identity; social perception of colour symbolism; variations in colour symbolism through history or across cultures; formal structures ▪ create an abstracted artwork using student choice of two-dimensional, three-dimensional or time-based media.	
		Focus: Repetition Context: Formal — placement of visual components • Responding: – students ▪ decode artworks as abstracted interpretations of occupied space through installation ▪ discuss how repetition empowers artists to create meaning; rainbow art and colour theory in contemporary installation; sensory perception in installations ▪ undertake a case study, e.g. ○ Nike Savvas, *Atomic: full of love, full of wonder*, 2005 ○ Mikala Dwyer, *Square Cloud Compound*, 2010 ○ Ernesto Neto, *Mother body emotional densities, for alive temple time baby son*, 2007. • Extended paragraph focus questions: – Reverse chronology question based on the work of Mikala Dwyer, *Hanging Eyes*, 1999; Richard Van Buren, *For Najeeb*, 1972 – Question 1: How do artists manipulate materials and techniques to enhance meaning? Analyse and compare the application of materials and techniques in the work of two artists through the formal context. Interpret the stylistic qualities relative to historical periods or iconology and discuss how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning. – Comparative analysis question based on seen and unseen work. Select one case study artwork and either Toshiko Horiuchi MacAdam, *Harmonic Motion*, 2013 or Gabriel Dawe, *Plexus No. 29*, 2015. – Question 2: How is knowledge of art conventions and symbols applied by the viewer when decoding artworks? Evaluate the application of visual language, symbols and experiences in the work of two artists through the formal context. Justify how shared knowledge engages audiences and assists meaning by decoding the selected artworks. • Making: – students ▪ consider structures in natural or built environments that create form through connecting lines, e.g. spider webs, vines in a rainforest, telegraph lines, tree branches, clotheslines, chandeliers ▪ working collaboratively, select a product or material and deliberately use repetition, colour gradients, pattern, shape and texture to create an installation; use shared cultural iconography and/or symbols.	• Found objects repurposed, materials to suspend work, e.g. fishing line, string, cord **Suggested artists/artworks** • Ernesto Neto, *Mother body emotional densities, for alive temple time baby son*, 2007, MCASD 2015–2016, Museum of Contemporary Art San Diego, www.tanyabonakdargallery.com/exhibitions/229-ernesto-neto-mother-body-emotional-densities-for-alive-mca-san-diego • Gabriel Dawe, *Plexus No. 29*, 2015, www.gabrieldawe.com/plexus-no-29 • Mikala Dwyer, *Hanging Eyes*, 1999, www.artgallery.nsw.gov.au/collection/works/129.2002.a-i • Museum of Contemporary Art, *Mikala Dwyer, Square Cloud Compound, 2010*, www.mca.com.au/collection/artworks/2015.63A-D • Nike Savvas, *Atomic: full of love, full of wonder*, 2005, Art Gallery of New South Wales, www.artgallery.nsw.gov.au/collection/works/316.2006 • Richard Van Buren, *For Najeeb*, 1972, https://searchthecollection.nga.gov.au/object/47767 • Richman-Abdou, K 2017, '10 avant-garde artists whose rainbow art installations will mesmerize you', *My Modern Met*, 10 April, www.mymodernmet.com/rainbow-art-installations • Toshiko Horiuchi MacAdam, *Harmonic Motion*, 2013, www.itsliquid.com/toshiko-horiuchi-macadam.html

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
3 hours	**Key terminology** How do artists and audiences write and talk about art? Students: • apply visual art terminology when writing about and talking about artworks of self and others as they become familiar with the following key terms: – aesthetic — considerations within the visual arts usually associated with the sense of vision; an art image or object is perceived spatially by recognised associations with form and context; the form of the work can be subject to an aesthetic as much as the content – artist's statement — brief written text that accompanies the display of artwork; assists the viewer to understand the purpose or motivations behind the artwork; interpretative rather than descriptive – culture — diverse knowledge, beliefs, values and perspectives that members of a group share and embody in their rituals, roles, relationships and customs – decode — extract meaning by considering the application of visual language in artworks – display — involves presenting art images and objects through public exhibition or personal display; display is an important part of providing and responding to inherent meaning in artwork and is an intrinsic process in art-making; display can be physically installed in a space or place, or it can be virtual or digital, particularly when used to demonstrate intended ideas that cannot be realised in a practical sense – iconography — a set of symbols or images used in art forms that are recognised by other people as having a particular meaning – literal meaning — visual components in an artwork that are meant to be interpreted as they appear – non-literal meaning — symbolic visual components that can be interpreted in multiple ways and used to signify something else – reconstruction — where the imagery or text is re-formed to create a different meaning, modifying or parodying the original.	**Focus: Changing** Context: Formal — visual language • Responding: – students ▪ respond to stimulus — view the interactive work of Miguel Chevalier in the *Magic Carpets* series ▪ discuss the innovative, expressive and non-linguistic symbols used in this ephemeral work; how audience engages with the work and reacts to their experience of it; how artists use technology to create sensory experiences for audiences; students' experiences with interactive spaces, e.g. art galleries, science exhibits, amusement park rides. • Making: – students ▪ create a 30–60-second video projection that engages the audience through sensory experiences ▪ exploit formal properties of colour, time, movement, sound, silence, rhythm, lighting, sequence, pace and focus ▪ experiment with production (e.g. camera movement and position, lighting) and post-production (e.g. slow-motion, reversing, separating and mismatching sound and image) techniques that can manipulate senses.	**Suggested artists/artworks** • *Miguel Chevalier 'Magic Carpets 2016' Milton Keynes (UK)*, www.vimeo.com/175555433
9 hours		**Focus: Abstracted land** Context: Formal and cultural — stylistic qualities and identity • Artist-in-residence: Jacqueline Scotcher: – students ▪ experience local artist's interpretation of landscape through colour, texture, shifting perspectives and selected motifs ▪ listen to additional artist talks by Samantha Hobson and Rosella Namok. • Responding: – students ▪ using a local focus (FNQ), investigate contemporary female artists who document landscape and connect to place through symbolic abstraction and use of colour ▪ discuss how these artists inspire viewers to rethink familiar environments or approach new landscapes in innovative ways; different art-making practices and cultural meaning. • Making: – students ▪ investigate natural landscapes that present colourful abstracted imagery through colour (element) and pattern (principle), e.g. rice terraces, northern lights, satellite photographs, local places using online satellite maps ▪ create a painting (acrylic, gouache, enamel, spray, oil, encaustic and mediums) that interprets connection to a familiar environment ▪ consider ○ shapes, symbols and signs to communicate connection ○ colours that reflect cultural connection to selected place	**Suggested artists/artworks and stimulus** • Gordon Moore, K 2015, 'Celebrating the Northern Lights of Aurora Borealis', *From Behind the Pen*, 11 December, www.frombehindthepen.wordpress.com/2015/12/11/celebrating-the-northern-lights-of-aurora-borealis • Jacqueline Scotcher, *Trilogy (2015 exhibition)*; *Wayfaring (2017 exhibition) including Hinchinbrook Island Walk No. 1*, 2016, www.jacquelinescotcher.com • *Lockhart River Art Gang artist Samantha Hobson discusses her art work and journey*, www.youtube.com/watch?v=Rj34UzJcisM • National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA), *Earth as art* (gallery of satellite photographs), www.nasa.gov/connect/ebooks/earth_art_detail.html • Rosella Namok, *Travel to Cairns*, 2005; *Mangroves Down by the River*, 2003, www.japingkaaboriginalart.com/collections/rosella-namok • Samantha Hobson, *Big Reef*, 2008, https://octobergallery.co.uk/exhibitions/2008hob • Samantha Hobson, *Burning Time at the Hill*, 2003, https://learning.qagoma.qld.gov.au/artworks/burn-grass-season • Yahoo! News, *China's rice terraces — The most beautiful in the world* (Yahoo News Photo, 24 September 2016), www.yahoo.com/news/china-rice-terraces-most-beautiful-192033729.html?fr=sycsrp_catchall

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
		○ changing viewing perspectives (topographical, bird's-eye view, elevation) ○ innovative mark-making and unconventional approaches with materials and techniques, e.g. using hands, sticks, smearing, layering, gouging.	
12 hours	**Resolving** Students: • resolve an artwork to extend an experimental folio as they communicate in visual and written responses • realise – an artwork to communicate an individualised focus through selection and manipulation of art media – by considering how specific display possibilities of two-dimensional, three-dimensional and time-based media artworks can enhance the communication of art meaning and transcend language, such as site-specific, interactivity and sensory experiences – written responses that support claims and viewpoints about artworks. **Key terminology** How do artists and audiences write and talk about art? Students: • apply visual art terminology when writing about and talking about artworks of self and others as they become familiar with the following key terms: – resolve — consolidate and communicate intent through a synthesis of ideas and application of media to express meaning.	**Resolved work** • Responding: – students ▪ review all experimental work from the six teacher-directed focus areas and select one area for extension to create a resolved artwork ○ cultural signals — cultural and formal context ○ statistically speaking — formal context ○ gender-specific — cultural context ○ repetition — formal context ○ changing — formal context ○ abstracted land — cultural and formal context ▪ establish an inquiry question relating to the chosen focus that identifies an individual interest and can deepen the scope of the inquiry ▪ research new ideas and identify and test alternate solutions inspired by research to extend the knowledge of the chosen focus through formal and cultural contexts. • Making: – students ▪ consolidate, refine and resolve an idea by exploring two-dimensional, three-dimensional or time-based media to extend one experimental artwork into a resolved work or alternate a previous experimental artwork stemming from one of the six focus areas ▪ develop a response from their own thoughts and imagination by putting elements together into a new pattern or structure to form a coherent or functional whole ▪ resolve and communicate intended meaning. Resolving is the point where communication of meaning and understanding is clearly evident. It demonstrates synthesis of ideas as a result of researching, developing and reflecting. Characteristics of resolved work in inquiry phase 2 include ○ evidence of depth of research, development and critical reflection ○ communication of personal aesthetic ○ a degree of 'finish', showing knowledge and understanding of media and technical skills ○ end-points are reached ○ concept, focus, contexts and media areas are used to solve complex problems of visual language and expression.	• Visual Art reflection teacher supporting resource
		• Responding: – students ▪ write a reflective statement to support the experimental folio and the selection of work ▪ consider obstacles, challenges, successes	

Time	Subject matter	Learning experiences	Resources
		▪ write an artist statement to display with the resolved work that communicates individual interpretation of the focus and how the inquiry was developed through further investigation. • Making: – students ▪ select four experimental artworks for inclusion in assessment folio considering ○ demonstration of engagement in inquiry learning process divergent thinking ○ experimentation with ideas, representations and media ▪ display the resolved work to enhance communication of meaning and intentions.	
2 hours	**Researching** Students: • analyse and compare artworks through the cultural context to interpret social influences and representations of time, place, politics, purpose, ethnicity, gender and spiritual and secular beliefs on visual language and communication, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning through – responding, students consider Aboriginal perspectives; regional, national, international, social and cultural identity of artists and audiences; and how artists use their work as a vehicle to invite change and provoke conversation • analyse and compare artworks through the formal context to interpret formal visual art elements and principles, the application of materials and techniques, the stylistic qualities relative to historical periods or iconology, and how these contribute to engagement, communication and meaning; through – responding, students decode artworks by reading the relationships between specific visual language, signs, symbols, codes, and conventions that are used to transmit information and ideas in artworks. **Resolving** Students: • apply – literacy knowledge and skills to understand form and structure of extended paragraphs and essay responses – visual art terminology when decoding and verbalising visual clues and symbols in artworks of self and others – language conventions to construct written responses that analyse, interpret, evaluate and justify visual language, expression and meaning in artworks – referencing conventions to acknowledge sourced information and ideas when researching artists and their practices, and developing artwork approaches • realise – written responses that support claims and viewpoints about artworks.	**Formative assessment: Examination** • Responding: – students ▪ undertake an examination under examination conditions ▪ are provided with options through differentiated questions to draw upon knowledge of artists and artworks from six focus areas covered in experimental folio ▪ are provided with stimulus representing two-dimensional, three-dimensional and time-based media ▪ are provided with formal context stimulus such as Dale Frank, *Ebenezer*, 2008; Hany Armanious, *Snake Oil*, 1994; and *Untitled Snake Oil*, 2015; Choi Jeong Hwa, *Happy Happy*, 2015 ▪ are provided with cultural context stimulus such as Paul Bong, *Crossroads*, 2015; Ah Xian, *China, China – Bust 81*, 2004; Deborah Kelly, *Beware of the God*, 2004, 2008 ▪ are provided with brief context statements to support understanding of unseen artworks and/or relevant art practices ▪ answer examination questions selected from the formal and cultural context guiding questions established at the beginning of the unit.	• Examination paper **Suggested artists/artworks** • Ah Xian, *China, China – Bust 81*, 2004, www.mca.com.au/collection/artworks/2008.21 • Choi Jeong Hwa, *Happy Happy*, 2015, www.artsy.net/artwork/choi-jeong-hwa-happy-happy • Dale Frank, *Ebenezer*, 2008, https://ipswichartgallery.qld.gov.au/collection/modern-and-contemporary-art-collection • Deborah Kelly, *Beware of the God*, 2004, 2008, https://backspace.com/notes/2005/12/beware-of-the-god.php • Hany Armanious, *Snake Oil*, 1994; *Untitled Snake Oil*, 2015, www.mca.com.au/collection/artworks/2009.89 • Paul Bong, *Crossroads*, 2015, www.fireworksgallery.com.au/artist/paul-bong

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